

SEPTEMBER 2026 BRIEFING

Sonardyne in Brazil

Pre-salt projects, partners and new technology

On Demand Ocean Bottom Nodes at Mero, optical data harvesting and the fleet behind Brazil's deepwater operations

Based on trade press and company news to September 2026



Three things to know



20+

years in Brazil

Local office, in-country support
and Portuguese-speaking
engineers since the 2000s



84

OD OBNs at Mero

First field deployment of On
Demand Ocean Bottom Nodes,
early 2026



2027

commercial production

Scale-up could mean hundreds or
thousands of nodes per field

Two decades on the ground built today's trust

2015

2016

2018

2020

2025

2026

Second office opens in central Rio, alongside the Rio das Ostras base

Ranger 2 + GyroUSBL 7000 on Fugro Aquarius for Petrobras ROV work to 3,000 m

OD OBN programme starts with Shell, Petrobras and SENAI CIMATEC

Orders from OceanPact and C-Innovation (six vessels)

OD OBN final tests after 2,000+ days of deepwater trials

First 84 OD OBNs deployed at Mero



Portuguese-speaking support staff are a key reason operators stay with Sonardyne.

C-Innovation, 2022 case study. Sonardyne Brasil Ltda kept its office open through downturns and COVID-19.

Operators, researchers and vessel owners



Operators

Petrobras

Mero operator; R&D via CENPES

Shell Brasil

Co-leads OD OBN; 19.3% of Mero

Karoon Energy

Client for C-Innovation's Cabo Frio



Research & funding

SENAI CIMATEC

Co-manufactures nodes at Camaçari

ANP

Regulator; funds OD OBN via R&D clause

Saipem

FlatFish AUV harvests node data



Vessel operators

C-Innovation

ROV/IMR fleet: Ranger 2, SPRINT-Nav, Fusion 2

Fugro

Fugro Aquarius: Ranger 2 + GyroUSBL 7000

OceanPact

Ranger 2 on geoscience vessels for Petrobras

OD OBN: 4D monitoring without node recovery

Semi-permanent seabed seismic nodes for low-cost 4D reservoir monitoring of the pre-salt

2,000+

days of deepwater trials at Sapinhoá, Itapu and Búzios

660

pre-production nodes in the pilot array

84

nodes in the first Mero deployment, early 2026

5 yrs

design life on the seabed, rated to 3,000 m

WHY IT MATTERS



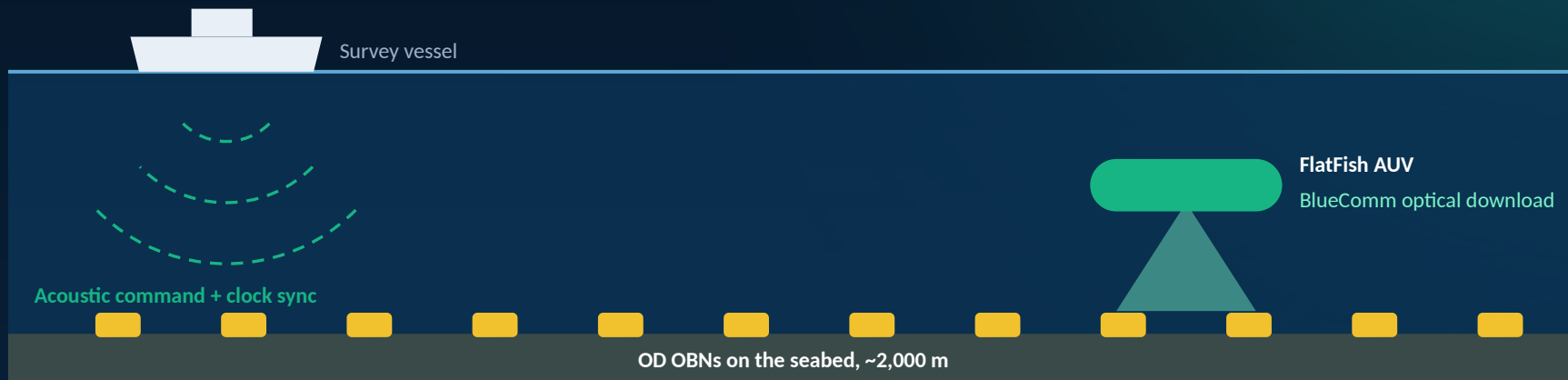
No repeat deployment and recovery: data is harvested wirelessly, on demand



Lower greenhouse-gas emissions from seismic acquisition and more offshore automation (Petrobras CENPES)

HOW IT WORKS

Acoustics to control, optics to collect



1 Deploy

Nodes left over the reservoir for years

2 Sync

Acoustic commands start recording and sync clocks

3 Record

Capture energy reflected from the reservoir

4 Harvest

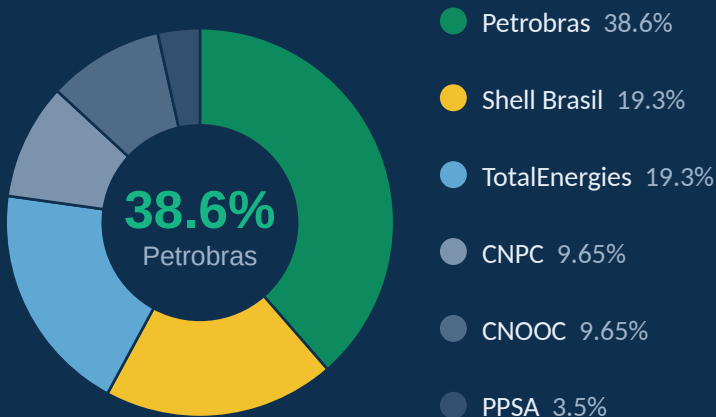
AUV pulls data over a BlueComm optical link

5 Process

4D workflows track fluid movement

Mero: first field deployment in the pre-salt

Mero consortium share



Santos Basin pre-salt, ~2,000 m water depth



First 84 nodes of the pilot batch placed early 2026



Commercial production expected 2027

"Seeing the OD OBN system successfully deployed at Mero is a strong validation of the technology and the collaborative R&D behind it."

Shaun Dunn, Sonardyne (JPT, June 2026)

Four building blocks behind the programme



BlueComm optical comms

2.5–10 Mbps

up to 75 m; rated to 4,000 m. 9 GB+ moved on one lithium D-cell



Wideband acoustic control

100s of nodes

Long-range commands and seismic-grade clock sync, from 6G heritage



Resident AUV harvesting

No recovery

Saipem FlatFish collects data wirelessly; ROV retrieval as fallback



Made in Brazil

600 / year

Planned capacity at CIMATEC PARK, Camaçari, Bahia

Positioning Brazil's deepwater fleet



Ranger 2 USBL

C-Innovation, Fugro, OceanPact

Tracks ROVs, corers and towed sensors; DP reference



GyroUSBL 7000

Fugro Aquarius

Transceiver + survey-grade INS in one unit, to 3,000 m



SPRINT-Nav

C-Innovation

Pre-calibrated INS, DVL and depth; cuts ROV set-up time



Fusion 2 LBL

C-Innovation

Real-time SLAM calibration; fewer Compaths to deploy

THE BENCHMARK

< 5 m

error at 1,000 m water depth

95% of positions within 0.5% of water depth, while the vessel is moving

What comes next

NOW



Survey & retrieve

Seismic shoot over Mero, then optical data recovery from the nodes

NEXT



Prove the value

4D processing and assessment of how the data supports reservoir management

2027+



Scale up

Commercial production from 2027; full fields may need hundreds or thousands of nodes

CONTEXT



Kraken ownership

Sonardyne joined Kraken Robotics with the Covelya acquisition on 2 July 2026

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Brazil is where next-generation seabed monitoring goes live

01

Local presence and Portuguese-speaking support underpin long-term operator relationships

02

OD OBN has moved from 2,000+ days of trials to a live deployment at Mero

03

Acoustic control and optical harvesting make repeat 4D surveys cheaper and lower-emission

Sources

- JPT (SPE), 19 June 2026: New seismic acquisition technology advances offshore Brazil
- Kraken Robotics, 20 July 2026: \$35 million in new orders and business update
- Offshore Magazine, 15 Jan 2026: On-demand OBN system enhances surveillance of Brazil's presalt fields
- Marine Technology News: On-Demand Ocean Bottom Node, a new era in deepwater seismic monitoring
- Sonardyne: OD OBN case study; OD OBN phase release (June 2024); C-Innovation case study (Oct 2022); OceanPact release (June 2020); second Brazil office (May 2015); BlueComm 200 UV product page
- Offshore Magazine, Sept 2016: Sonardyne delivers subsea technology to Fugro vessel offshore Brazil
- Keyfacts Energy, Oct 2020: C-Innovation selects Sonardyne technology

Node counts differ between sources over time (600 planned in 2024; 660 in production in 2026).